CHRONOLOGY OF EVENTS 1960-1995

The main purpose of this chronology is to help the reader by reconstructing MSF's actions and public statements in regional and international news reports of the period. It is intended as a tool for this specific document, and not as an academic reference.

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1960	Unification of Italian Somalia and British Somaliland into the independent Republic of Somalia.			
1963-64	**October 1963-April 1964** 1st Ogaden war between Ethiopia and Somalia.			
1969	Siad Barre coup – dictatorship.			
1977-78	2nd Ogaden war. Ethiopia holds on to sovereignty over the Ogaden.			
1979-87			MSF France provides assistance to the refugees from Ogaden (Hiran, Gedo).	
1985	Start of SNM rebellion in the north of Somalia.		MSF France supports Ethiopian refugees around Hargeisa (Somaliland).	
1986			MSF Holland develops medical programmes in the northwest of Somalia.	
1987			**10 January 1987** MSF France international staff taken hostage in Tug Wajale. Closure of MSF France programmes in Somalia.	

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1988	**May 1988** SNM offensive on Hargeisa and Burao – hundreds of Somali refugees in Ethiopia.		Suspension of MSF Holland programme in northwest of Somalia.	
1989	USC rebels begin underground resistance in central and southern Somalia.		**January 1989** MSF Holland resumes activities in Boroma.	
1989 **MAY 1989**			**May 1989** Interruption of MSF Holland Boroma programme and evacuation of international staff.	
1990 **JAN. 1990** **MAR. 1990** **MAY 1990**	**May 1990** 114 clan leaders issue the Mogadishu Manifesto, which condemns the actions of the Siad Barre regime.		**January 1990** MSF Holland revives health centres in villages around Alei Badei. **March 1990** MSF France exploratory mission in refugee camps in Boroma. **April 1990** MSF Holland team evacuates Boroma after a car looting.	

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1990 **JULY 1990**	**July 1990** Elections called for February. **July-August 1990** Attacks and roadside bombings against the structures of the Siad Barre regime and foreign nationals.			
OCT. 1990	**October 1990** Opposition parties agree to bring down the government by force.			
DEC. 1990	**December 1990** SNM controls the north. USC gains ground. Siad Barre declares a state of emergency. Mogadishu is paralysed. UN humanitarian personnel evacuate from Mogadishu.			
1991 **JAN. 1991**		**2 January 1991** Gulf War starts.	**2 January 1991** Decision to make an 'MSF Europe' surgical mission in Mogadishu, including MSF Belgium and MSF France, and MSF Holland staff.	**4 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Charters a Plane to Somalia'. **5 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Plane has not Received Permission to Land at Mogadishu'.

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1991 **JAN. 1991**				**6 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Part of the Médecins Sans Frontières Team has left Mombasa for Mogadishu'. MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Team Unable to Reach Mogadishu'.
			7 January 1991 MSF team arrives in Mogadishu and sets up in Digfer general hospital.	**7 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Team Arrived in Mogadishu'.
				8 January 1991 MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Team in Mogadishu'
			9 January 1991 MSF gets in touch with USC in Rome.	**9 January 1991** MSF issues official appeal for half a day's ceasefire. Reuters & *Libération*: "according to the MSF team" the government still controls Mogadishu.
				10 January 1991 MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières in Somalia: Injured Flock to Mogadishu Hospital'.
	12 January 1991 The Italian Embassy in Somalia evacuates the last foreign nationals who had taken refuge within its walls.		**11-12 January 1991** MSF gets in touch with USC in London.	**12 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Team Stays in Mogadishu'.

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1991 **JAN. 1991**			**13 January 1991** MSF exploratory mission in USC areas – a driver is wounded.	
				14 January 1991 MSF Belgium Press Release: 'Emergency aid in Somalia – Médecins Sans Frontières Team Fired Upon as it Crosses the Frontline'. MSF Belgium Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Working on Both Sides of the Front'. MSF France Press Release: 'Update on Médecins Sans Frontières' Emergency Response in Mogadishu'.
				15 January 1991 MSF France Press Release: 'Correction: None Wounded Among the Médecins Sans Frontières Team in Mogadishu'.
			16 January 1991 Evacuation of MSF team from Mogadishu for safety reasons.	**16 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'The Médecins Sans Frontières Team Leaves Mogadishu'.
				18 January 1991 *Libération* (France): testimony from the MSF team evacuated from Mogadishu.
			23 January 1991 MSF team back to Somalia, meets the rebels and sets up in SOS hospital in USC zone.	**23 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Working Again in Mogadishu'.

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1991				
JAN. 1991				**27 January 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Team Overwhelmed by Influx of Wounded'. **28 January 1991** Reuters, BBC, *NYT*: according to an MSF representative, President Siad Barre has fled his presidential palace.
			30 January 1991 Evacuation of MSF team from Mogadishu for safety reasons.	
FEB. 1991			**1 February 1991** New team of 4 MSF medical doctors in Medina hospital in Mogadishu.	
	2 February 1991 Interim President Ali Mahdi calls for international aid.			
				10 February 1991 MSF in Press Release: "Médecins Sans Frontières reaffirms its complete neutrality". MSF France launches the *Extreme Emergencies* magazine to donors. **20 February 1991** Reuters: 'Signs of Malnutrition in Somalia, French Doctors Say'.

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1991				
FEB. 1991	**21 February 1991** Failure of national reconciliation process; mushrooming of rival factions.			
			24 February-3 March 1991 MSF Holland exploratory mission in the north of Somalia (border with Ethiopia).	
MAR. 1991		**March 1991** Rebellion of Kurds in Iraq, repressed by the regime.	**Early March 1991** MSF Holland starts a medico-surgical project in Hargeisa hospital that will later be extended to Burao and Sheikh hospitals. An MSF office is opened in Berbera.	**6 March 1991** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Intervenes in Somalia's North', Reuters (UK): 'Doctors Report Northern Somalian Town Devastated by Civil War'.
			Mid-March 1991 Difficulties for MSF supply due to Kenya denial of take-off clearance toward Mogadishu to private aircrafts.	**March 1991** MSF France: Letter to donors containing testimonials from an MSF surgeon and a journalist.
APRIL 1991		**April 1991** Kurds flee Iraqi troops toward Turkey and Iran.	**April 1991** MSF largest-ever aid operation to bring aid to Kurds.	
		5 April 1991 United Nations Resolution 688, calling on Iraq to end repression of its population.		
		6 April 1991 Operation 'Provide Comfort' (USA and Gulf War allies) to bring humanitarian relief to the Kurds.		

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1991				
APRIL 1991			**20-21 April 1991 and 29 April-2 May 1991** MSF France exploratory missions in Kismayo.	
MAY 1991	**18 May 1991** SNM declares unilateral independence of Somaliland. Meeting of Somali factions in Djibouti: Ali Mahdi confirmed as Interim President. Aidid and Somaliland disagree.	**Late May 1991** Tigrayans take power in Ethiopia. Massive return of Ethiopian refugees to their country and influx of Somali and South Sudanese refugees.		**27 May 1991** Reuters (UK): 'Catastrophe Threatens Ethiopian Refugee Camps, Doctors Say'.
JUNE 1991			**June 1991** MSF Belgium and MSF Holland leave 'MSF Europe' mission in Mogadishu. MSF Holland extends programmes in north Somalia: support to mine clearing with Rimfire.	
JULY 1991	**July 1991** 6 Somali factions sign a ceasefire and agree to expel Siad Barre.		**July 1991** MSF France starts a programme of reconstructive surgery in Mogadishu.	

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1991 **JULY 1991**				**27 July 1991** *The New York Times Magazine* (USA), 'Daring to heal', by Kathleen Hunt – account of MSF team life and activities in Mogadishu.
AUG. 1991	**August 1991** Restart of fighting between Siad Barre forces and USC. Restart of UN operations in Mogadishu.			
SEPT. 1991		**8-10 September 1991** Fighting between Ali Mahdi and Aidid troops. Aidid demands Mahdi's resignation.	**September 1991** François Jean (MSF France): MSF is too close to the Habr Gedir clan. MSF team evacuates from Mogadishu because of fighting.	
	17 September 1991 Red Cross plane hit over Berbera.			
	27 September 1991 UN suspends its aid operations in Mogadishu.			
			30 September 1991 MSF Belgium informs MSF France it won't be able to take charge of a Kismayo programme due to lack of staff.	
OCT. 1991	**2 October 1991** Formation of a new Somali government rejected by Aidid. Observers predict rising tensions.			

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1991				
OCT. 1991	**11 October 1991** Ali Mahdi calls on the international community to deliver urgent food aid.			
		15 October 1991 WFP announces that 4.5 million Somalis risk dying of hunger.		
			17 October 1991 Decision by the MSF France management committee: no opening in Kismayo until the team in Mogadishu is complete.	
	23 October 1991 Somali government accuses the forces loyal to Siad Barre of committing acts of genocide.			
NOV. 1991		**7 November 1991** SCF: The arrival of Somali refugees and Ethiopian returnees in Ogaden carries risk of a food crisis for the region.		
	17 November 1991 Extremely violent fighting resumes between troops of Ali Mahdi and Aidid in Mogadishu.		**November 1991** Within 15 days, 2,000 injured treated in Medina hospital. MSF and ICRC are the only relief agencies operating in Mogadishu.	
				20 November 1991 MSF France coordinator to AFP (France): about 400 injured admitted to the hospital since Sunday.

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1991 **NOV. 1991**				**26 November 1991** MSF France Regional Office for East Africa Press Release: 1,500 wounded hospitalised in Mogadishu. MSF calls for a ceasefire.
DEC. 1991	**December 1991** Total war in Mogadishu, looted and destroyed by Aidid's forces, bombing blocks access to harbour.		**December 1991** MSF Belgium explo in Kismayo. MSF Holland explo in the north. MSF difficulties with supply because blockage of ICRC boat by bombing in the harbour. MSF France considers doing an evaluation of the nutritional situation in Merca. Meetings between MSF France senior executives and the 2 war chiefs/clan leaders.	
	11 December 1991 1 ICRC employee and 1 Somali Red Crescent employee fatally wounded in Mogadishu during a food distribution.			
	13 December 1991 Hashi Egal (USPF) calls for an armed, international intervention.			**13 December 1991** AFP (France): 'No More Blood for Somali Wounded, Doctor Says'.
			15 December 1991 Andrew Natsios (OFDA): Announces that the USA would double its emergency aid. Criticises the incapacity of the UN to deliver assistance to the civilian population. US State Department calls on international community to stop 'absurd slaughter'.	

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1991 **DEC. 1991**	**20 December 1991** Humanitarian aid flights for Mogadishu resume.	**23 December 1991** ICRC calls on the UN to 'act urgently'. **27 December 1991** Javier Perez de Cuellar, UN Secretary General, announces the dispatch of a small team into Mogadishu and the plan for progressive reinforcement of aid.		
1992 **JAN. 1992**	**January 1992** Fighting in Burao (north of Somalia). **5 January 1992** UNICEF physician killed by bandits in the north. **14 January 1992** ICRC employee killed in Kismayo.	**6 January 1992** James Jonah, UN Secretary General Special Envoy in Somalia, declares pessimism that a ceasefire could be possible. **Mid-January 1992** ICRC issues alert on the nutritional situation in the camps looted outside Mogadishu – organises wet kitchens.	**5 January 1992** A shell hits Banaadir hospital, where an MSF team is working. **6 January 1992** Withdrawal of 5 MSF international staff from Somalia. **15 January 1992** MSF Holland evacuates Burao with 300 wounded.	**6 January 1992** MSF France Press Release: 'For Security Reasons Médecins Sans Frontières is Recalling Part of its Team from Mogadishu'. **15 January 1992** MSF France and MSF Holland Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Evacuates from Burao for Security Reasons'.

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1992				
JAN. 1992	**16 January 1992** ICRC: hundreds of thousands of Somalis are suffering from the famine.			**20 January 1992** MSF France and MSF Holland Press Release: 'MSF Increases its Assistance in the North of Somalia'.
		23 January 1992 UN Security Council imposes an arms embargo.		
				29 January 1992 MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins sans Frontières Speaks Out on the Situation in Somalia'.
				30 January 1992 MSF Press conference: MSF France Deputy Director of Operations and MSF Holland President in New York: 'Médecins Sans Frontières – Humanitarian Emergency in Somalia'.
		31 January 1992 UNSG and director general of UNICEF call for emergency humanitarian aid in the Horn of Africa.		
FEB. 1992	**14 February 1992** Ceasefire under UN supervision between Aidid and Ali Mahdi forces.		**February 1992** MSF France opens a programme in the refugee camp in Liboi (Kenya).	**February 1992** MSF France message broadcast on Somali radio: hospitals should be considered neutral zones.

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1992				
FEB. 1992			**22 February-3 March 1992** Exploratory mission of MSF Belgium programme manager to Merca and Kismayo.	
MAR. 1992				**3 March 1992** *Libération* (France): 'Drugs and the Security of Foreigners, Mothers of the War in Somalia', by Stephen Smith.
			5 March 1992 MSF France's management committee asks Serge Manoncourt (Epicentre) to conduct a nutritional evaluation of the situation outside Mogadishu.	
				10 March 1992 MSF France sends information letter to donors about Somalia.
			Late March 1992 MSF Belgium starts medico-surgical and nutritional assistance to Kismayo.	
APRIL 1992			**1-2 April 1992** MSF France coordinator in Mogadishu carries out a preparatory mission for the nutritional assessment in the Merca region.	**April 1992** Proposal for an MSF press officer in the Horn of Africa refused by coordinators.
				21 April 1992 MSF France on TF1 news: footage on the evaluation team in Merca and coordinator interview.

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1992 **APR. 1992**		**24 April 1992** UNSC Resolution 751: 50 UN military observers to monitor ceasefire and distribution of food aid. **27 April 1992** Mohamed Sahnoun appointed UN special envoy to Somalia.	**18-28 April 1992** MSF France epidemiological survey in the Merca and Qoryooley districts among a population of around 100,000 inhabitants, residents, and displaced. In displaced camps 90% of children under 5 are malnourished, 75% of them severely.	
MAY 1992	**May 1992** Siad Barre flees to Kenya after failing to take back Mogadishu. Supply resumed via Mogadishu port, UN observers deployed in Mogadishu. **15 May 1992** Kismayo falls into the hands of USC.	**Late May 1992** SCF launches a famine alert.	**May 1992** MSF Holland international staff evacuated from Hargeisa and Burao: remote control management until November. **15 May 1992** MSF Belgium team in Kismayo evacuates.	**21 May 1992** MSF France press conference: - Results of Merca/Qoryooley epidemiological survey. - Famine alert. - Appeal for massive aid distribution. **23 May 1992** MSF France president's annual report: "awareness-raising activities on the famine are equally as important as the operational activities."

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1992				
MAY 1992			**End May 1992** Opening of an MSF France nutritional programme in Merca.	
JUNE 1992		**June 1992** End of MSF operations in Kurdistan.	**June 1992** MSF Belgium team back to Kismayo.	**18 June 1992** Reuters: 'Medical Charity says Africans Dying due to Indifference'. MSF quote. **26 June 1992** MSF France Board of Directors debate on the relevance and capacity of the organisation to undertake large-scale food aid distributions.
			29 June 1992 MSF France explo in Baidoa – 'worse than Merca'. MSF sections' directors of operations' decision to open a position for a communication officer for the Horn of Africa, based in Nairobi.	
JULY 1992	**5 July 1992** 4 UN observers out of 47 have arrived in Mogadishu.		**6 July 1992** MSF Belgium team attacked and kidnapped for several hours in the Hagadera camp in Kenya.	

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1992 **JULY 1992**		**9 July 1992** ICRC launches a new aid appeal to save Somalis from famine. **10 July 1992** UN postpones arrival of observers following Aidid's opposition.		**12 July 1992** New MSF France Somalia programme manager to AFP (France), "People in the tens if not hundreds of thousands will die in the coming weeks." His comments are reported in *Le Monde* on 16 July. **Mid-July 1992** MSF France holds information breakfast with ambassadors in Paris.
	20 July 1992 Omar Arteh Ghalib, Interim Prime Minister of Somalia, calls for the reinforcement of humanitarian aid and for UN troops in Somalia.	**15 July 1992** UN appeals to the generosity of donor states on behalf of people in the Horn of Africa. **20 July 1992** UNSC agreement to deploy 51 ceasefire observers and 500 armed soldiers. **22 July 1992** US Senator Nancy Kassebaum, back from Somalia, calls for an immediate deployment of UN troops.		**20 July 1992** MSF Belgium Press Release on Kenya camps: 'MSF Places its Medical Activities on Standby to Call for Increased Protection of Aid Workers and Refugees'. **22 July 1992** Rony Brauman, President of MSF France Board of Directors, recommends that the US Congress implement a large-scale food aid operation.

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1992 **JULY 1992**		**24 July 1992** UNSG Boutros-Ghali reproaches the UNSC for neglecting the 'war of the poor' in Somalia for 'the war of the rich' in ex-Yugoslavia.	**24 July 1992** Having won police protection, MSF Belgium recommences activities in the Kenyan camps.	
	26 July 1992 4 Somali factions declare that the escort of humanitarian convoys is not necessary and recommend instead a national police force.			
		27 July 1992 UNSC Resolution 767 authorises increase in strength of the UN operation in Somalia: Technical mission to be sent to Somalia to investigate the terms for putting in place a force for peacekeeping and for protecting humanitarian programmes. Urgent organisation of an airlift to deliver food aid.		**27 July 1992** Rony Brauman, President of MSF France Board of Directors, quoted in *The Washington Post* (USA): '"If we continue this way, probably a whole generation will be gone within the year."'
		30 July 1992 Andrew Natsios, USAID lobbies for a massive food distribution secured by UN forces.		
AUGUST 1992				**4 August 1992** MSF international Press Release: 'Population Decimated by Famine on the Somali Coast'.

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1992 **AUG. 1992**		**9 August 1992** Mohamed Sahnoun, UN representative in Somalia to *Le Monde* (France): it is possible to avoid resorting to force.		**11 August 1992** MSF and other NGOs' Letter to UNSG Boutros-Ghali expressing concerns about Somalia.
		12 August 1992 Agreement between Mohamed Sahnoun, UN representative in Somalia and Somali factions on deployment of 500 Pakistani Blue Helmets. Mohamed Sahnoun calls on the international community to set up an airlift to carry international aid into Somalia.		
	15 August 1992 WFP airlift starts to Baidoa, flurry of media in Mogadishu and Baidoa.	**Mid-August 1992** WFP announces that without massive aid, 1.8 million people were threatened with starving to death.		
		17 August 1992 ICRC calls for more food aid.		**20 August 1992** MSF International Press Release: 'Discovery of a "Mortuary Zone" in Western Somalia'.
				30 August 1992 *The Sunday Times* (UK), 'The Clans and How they Affect Relief Work', by Geoff Prescott, MSF Holland Coordinator in Somaliland.

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1992				
AUG. 1992		**Late August 1992** The EU releases 6 million ECUS (euros) for emergency humanitarian aid to Somalia.		
SEPT. 1992		**1 September 1992** SCF to AFP/Reuters: the UN's record in Somalia is a "failure".	**1 September 1992** MSF communication officer for Horn of Africa starts in his position.	
		9 September 1992 UNSC accepts UNSG's request to increase the number of Blue Helmets deployed in Somalia to over 4,000 men.		**9 September 1992** MSF France President of Board of Directors Rony Brauman and MSF Holland General Director Jacques de Milliano press conference in Nairobi: Priority to massively increase the distribution of food aid. Doubts that the presence of UN troops will improve security for humanitarian operations in Somalia.
			10 September 1992 Réginald Moreels, MSF Belgium President of Board of Directors, internal note on MSF France and MSF Holland's public opposition to the Blue Helmet deployment.	**10-13 September 1992** Patrick Poivre d'Arvor, star presenter on French television in Mogadishu (with airfare paid by MSF France).
				10 September 1992 MSF France Press Release and interviews: 'Priority Must be Given to the Continuation and Decentralisation of Food Aid.' Unreleased MSF Belgium Press Release: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Belgium Declares itself in Favour of the Blue Helmet Deployment to Somalia'.

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1992 **SEPT. 1992**				**11 September 1992** Belgium ex-Prime Minister, Wilfried Martens, as MSF Belgium Envoy in Somalia, calls for the deployment of UN forces in order to protect the distribution of humanitarian aid.
	14 September 1992 Initial contingent of Blue Helmets arrives in Mogadishu.		**Mid-September 1992** MSF Holland opens an emergency medical programme in Baidoa in cooperation with MSF France, CARE International, Concern, UNICEF, ICRC. Agreement on MSF France being responsible for joint representation for the 2 sections with regards to the authorities in Mogadishu. MSF France opened programmes in Hudur and Wajid. MSF France coordinator facing some problems with the Aidid clan.	
	15 September 1992 WFP starts to drop food aid in isolated regions.			**15 September 1992** Rony Brauman, MSF France President of Board of Directors, to *La Croix* (France): it is necessary to delay sending the Blue Helmets to Somalia to avoid stirring up tension. **17 September 1992** MSF France Press Release: 'Médecins sans Frontières to the Rescue of Children in Hudur'.
			18 September 1992 5 MSF France employees and 2 journalists briefly taken hostage in Medina hospital.	

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1992 **SEPT. 1992**				**23 September 1992** MSF France's fundraising appeal for its aid operations in Somalia.
		24 September 1992 On return from Somali refugee camps in Kenya, Actress Audrey Hepburn, UNICEF's Special Ambassador, states that Somalia can still be saved.		
			Late September 1992 MSF France coordinator opposes MSF Belgium's desire to open a programme in Bardhere.	
OCT. 1992			**1 October 1992** MSF Switzerland opens a programme in Kansardhere (part of MSF France programme).	
				3 October 1992 Rony Brauman, MSF France President of Board of Directors in *Le Monde* (France): at the price of 20% of the total value in potential losses, international aid can produce real results, international protection would cost between 5 and 10 times more.
				5 October 1992 MSF Switzerland Press Release: 'MSF Switzerland Intervenes in Somalia to Assist 30,000 People'.

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1992 **OCT. 1992**	**8-11 October 1992** Suspension of food airlifts for 4 Somali towns.	**10 October 1992** UN asks the donor countries to support its '100-day action programme' of US$82.7 million to provide assistance to the Somalis.	**14 October 1992** Part of MSF Holland team in Baidoa is evacuated for 1 week following rumours of a possible attack on the town.	
		20 October 1992 France 'Day for Somalia' (school students asked to bring rice for Somalis).	**21 October 1992** Looting of the MSF Holland radio room in Baidoa.	
	23 October 1992 Suspension of food airlift at Bardhere. Aidid forces prevent international aid from deploying in the port and at Mogadishu airport. Aidid demands the constitution of a police unit with the help of international forces.	**27 October 1992** Mohamed Sahnoun, UN representative in Somalia, forced to resign.		

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1992				
OCT. 1992				**28 October 1992** MSF France Press Release: 'The Resignation of Mr Sahnoun Risks Compromising the Efforts Undertaken for Somalia'.
			Late October 1992 Medina hospital's staff on strike forbids access to MSF international staff at the hospital.	
NOV. 1992		**Early November 1992** In the USA, increasing demand for direct intervention by USA forces in the area most severely affected by the famine.	**Early November 1992** MSF France decides to close down its activities in the Medina hospital.	**Early November 1992** MSF France steps up advocacy with main stakeholders and decides to re-launch communications to highlight slow progress and mistakes of UN machine.
			7 November 1992 some of MSF Holland team in Baidoa evacuates again after 1 of them was shot at.	
			10 November 1992 MSF France headquarters decides that the coordinator of the mission, Patrick Vial, who had been receiving death threats over several months, must leave Somalia.	**10 November 1992** *Chicago Tribune* (USA): 'Fatal Sense of Resignation: Many Somalis Quietly Shun Aid, Await Death', by Liz Sly. MSF France team in Hudur attests that the death rate remains extremely high.
		12 November 1992 A food aid convoy is attacked near Baidoa, a strategic town for food distribution in the region most affected by famine.		**12 November 1992** *Le Monde* (France): 'Somalia: America Flies Over a Starving Country, by Brigitte Doppler and Frédéric Vigneau, MSF France team in Somalia.

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1992 **NOV. 1992**	**16 November 1992** Interim President Ali Mahdi threatens to bomb the port in Mogadishu. **20 November 1992** A group of NGOs refuses the protection of UN guards and relies on their own Somali guards. **24 November 1992** A shell hits a WFP ship in the port of Mogadishu. The airlift has been virtually suspended. **28 November 1992** Aidid declares his acceptance of a possible dispatch of 30,000 UN soldiers to Somalia to protect the distribution of food aid.	**27 November 1992** UN sources tells AFP of a possible deployment to Somalia of a UN-led multinational force, under USA command.	**21 November 1992** A weapon is aimed at 2 nurses from MSF Holland team in Baidoa.	**27 November 1992** *Libération* (France) : Rony Brauman, MSF France President of Board of Directors, argues against military intervention in the name of humanitarian aid (picked up by *The New York Times* USA). MSF internal position paper, Jacques de Miliano, MSF Holland President: 'MSF takes no position on the appropriateness of military intervention'.

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1992 **NOV. 1992**				**30 November 1992** MSF France Draft letter to UNSG: a range of precautions should be taken to ensure the intervention stays on track (cancelled on 1 December).
		Late November 1992 MSF Holland international staff return to Hargeisa and Burao.		
DEC. 1992		**3 December 1992** Meles Zenawi, President of Ethiopia, called on the international community to 'uphold the Somali people's pride'. UNSC Resolution 794: authorises the rollout of a military operation ('Restore Hope') in Somalia under the United States' command so as to "establish a secure environment for humanitarian relief operations".		
	4 December 1992 Under the glare of cameras, Bernard Kouchner, French Minister of Health and Humanitarian Affairs, carries sacks of rice collected by French school students on his shoulders. Massive arrival of journalists in Mogadishu: prices skyrocket. NGO international staff evacuated to avoid looting before the international force arrived. Armed groups leave Mogadishu for Baidoa: looting and violence.			**4 December 1992** MSF France Board votes against an MSF public positioning regarding the in-depth issues underlying the US troops' intervention in Somalia. Pierre Harzé, MSF Belgium's Communications Director to *Le Journal et Indépendance – Le Peuple* (Belgium): this intervention had become necessary, but it poses security risks for members of humanitarian organisations.

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1992 **DEC. 1992**			**5 December 1992** Evacuation of MSF Switzerland/MSF France team from Kansardhere, temporary closure of the mission. **5-16 December 1992** MSF Holland's international team in Baidoa reduced to 3 people.	
		6 December 1992 United States' Ambassador in Nairobi, Smith Hempstone: "If you liked Beirut, you're going to love Mogadishu."	**6 December 1992** 3 vehicles belonging to MSF and Catholic Relief Services are stolen in Kenya and driven to Somalia. Kenya announces the closure of its border with Somalia.	**7 December 1992** MSF Holland Press Release: 'Looting in Baidoa – the Slow Pace of Preparations for the Somali Intervention Increases the Risks'.
	8 December 1992 2 US fighter planes fly over Baidoa, accentuating the tensions among the armed groups.			
	9 December 1992 US troops land in Mogadishu with much media fanfare and take control of the city. Night of looting in Kismayo.	**9 December 1992** UN Secretary General, Boutros Boutros-Ghali, announces a 5-stage action plan "to extract Somalia from chaos".	**9-20 December 1992** After a night of looting, part of international staff from humanitarian organisations, including 7 MSF Belgium personnel based in Kismayo, evacuates to Nairobi.	**9 December 1992** The Globe and Mail (Canada): 'Baidoa Racked by Rush for Loot, "Bystander, 4, Shot in Chest"' quote from MSF team.

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1992 **DEC. 1992**				**10 December 1992** AFP (France): 'MSF's President Denounces the Grotesque Antics of Kouchner and his Bags of Rice'. Reuters: testimony from the coordinator of MSF Belgium on the situation in Kismayo.
	11 December 1992 Ali Mahdi and Aidid sign a peace agreement.			**11 December 1992** MSF Belgium letter to the Belgian Minister of Foreign Affairs, the Belgian Representative at the United Nations, and the Belgian Ambassador in Nairobi asking for information on the operational aims of Operation 'Restore Hope': MSF Belgium coordinator voices concerns about the risk of image-confusion between the MSF Belgium team in Kismayo and the contingent of Belgian soldiers due to arrive. MSF Holland Press Release: 'Despite the Fighting, Médecins Sans Frontières Continues to Offer Assistance in Baidoa'.
			15 December 1992-14 January 1993 MSF France conducts a nutritional survey in Hudur.	
				16 December 1992 MSF Holland Baidoa team to the media: "The president of the United States did not keep his promises."

	Somali crisis	International	MSF operations	MSF public statements and advocacy
1992 **DEC. 1992**	**17 December 1992** US troops and French foreign legion participating in Operation 'Restore Hope' finally deploy to Baidoa. **18 December 1992** 200 US soldiers land in Kismayo airport, disarm 1 NGO's guards and take off again. **20 December 1992** Belgian and US contingents land in Kismayo port. Food supply restarts. **25 December 1992** French contingent arrives in Hudur.		**19 December 1992** The MSF Holland in Baidoa is complete.	**28 December 1992** *Libération* (France): 'The Day the Soldiers Leave Somalia', editorial by Dominique Martin, MSF France Programme Manager. **29 December 1992** Réginald Moreels, President of MSF Belgium Board of Directors, to *The New York Times* (USA): the warlord Jess, who had initiated the violence, said that it would only last an evening.

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1992 **DEC. 1992**	**30 December 1992 - 1 January 1993** US President George Bush visits Somalia. Pictures with Ali Mahdi and Aidid. **31 December 1992** US troops in Merca. Somali armed groups depart from Mogadishu.			
1993 **JAN. 1993**	**2 January 1993** UNICEF representative in Kismayo is murdered by his own guards.		**1 January 1993** Near a Kismayo beach, the MSF Belgium team discovers the corpses of December's massacred victims.	**3 January 1993** MSF Belgium Press Release: 'The Death of a UNICEF Representative in Kismayo Could Have Been Avoided'. *Le Soir* (Belgium): Réginald Moreels, President of MSF Belgium Board of Directors, sets out criteria for when a humanitarian worker could call for a military intervention, once all diplomatic channels had been exhausted.

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1993 **JAN. 1993**		**4 January 1993** Military sources in Mogadishu announce that Operation 'Restore Hope' will come to an end by 20 January 1993 at the latest, to be replaced by an operation supported by the UN, 'UNOSOM II'.	**6 January 1993** MSF Belgium opens a programme in Bardhere.	**7 January 1993** *Le Soir* (Belgium) Wilfried Martens (ex-Prime Minister of Belgium), MSF Belgium Envoy in Somalia : the Somali paramilitary groups need disarming and a dialogue instigated with the Somali faction chiefs.
	14 January 1993 Kurt Lustenberger, the ICRC delegate in Bardhere, is murdered by looters.			
	15 January 1993 The Somali factions sign a ceasefire agreement and plan a reconciliation conference.			
	22-24 January 1993 Belgian paratroopers attacked by Morgan's forces in Kismayo.	**22 January 1993** The United States officially asks the UN Security Council to take command of the multinational task force in Somalia (UNITAF).		

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1993				
JAN. 1993			**23 January 1993** MSF Switzerland/MSF France mission in Kansardhere is re-opened after an assessment. MSF Belgium vehicle attacked by the population in Kismayo.	
			24 January 1993 MSF Belgium team evacuates Kismayo. MSF Holland vehicle attacked and guards injured in Baidoa.	**24 January 1993** MSF Belgium press release: 'Violent demonstrations in Kismayo. Médecins Sans Frontières forced to partially evacuate its teams.'
			26 January 1993 MSF Belgium team returns to Kismayo.	
			29 January 1993 MSF Belgium team evacuates from Bardhere.	
FEB. 1993				**4 February 1993** MSF France publishes results of an epidemiological survey in Hudur. Mortality rate remains 7 times higher than normal in displaced population. MSF renews its call on public generosity to improve this situation, which remains critical.

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1993				
FEB. 1993	**6 February 1993** UN launches a wide-scale operation to distribute food to the Mogadishu population in an attempt to bring down the price of staple items. For first time, US troops are target of stones by young Somalis.			
	22 February 1993 Kismayo falls into the hands of General Morgan, hundreds dead and injured. Valerie Place, a nurse working for the Irish organisation Concern, is killed during an attack on her vehicle by Somalis near Afgoye.		**22 February 1993** Some 100 people take refuge at the MSF Belgium base, protected by Belgian paratroopers, then replaced by American soldiers.	**22 February 1993** MSF Belgium Press Release: 'Somalia: Violent Combat Overnight in Kismayo.'
				24 February 1993 MSF France coordinator for the Horn of Africa calls for a press conference to condemn the loss of human life caused by Operation 'Restore Hope'.
	22-28 February 1993 Fighting between Morgan and Jess clans in Kismayo.		**27 February 1993** The MSF Holland team in Baidoa is attacked by its own armed guards.	
MARCH 1993			**March 1993** MSF Belgium team witnesses abuse by the Belgian paratroopers.	

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1993 **MAR. 1993**			**1 March 1993** Meeting of MSF Somalia programme managers on security: MSF Belgium – no further need of armed guards. MSF France and MSF Holland would like to reach this point, but they hadn't got there yet. **2 March 1993** MSF coordinators meeting in Nairobi and Mogadishu: - There is still an emergency humanitarian crisis in Somalia. - MSF should review its operational approach in this country, notably its dependence on armed guards or UNITAF forces. **3 March 1993** As a security preventive measure, MSF France evacuates from Kansardhere. MSF Holland in Baidoa under protection of Australian forces.	**2 March 1993** MSF Holland Press Release: 'MSF Fears Further Deterioration of the Security Situation in Baidoa'. **5 March 1993** MSF France Board debates the question of maintaining or potentially removing the teams from Somalia.

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1993 **MAR. 1993**			**8-12 March 1993** MSF France general director and programme manager visit the missions in Somalia, where a decision has been made to implement a disengagement process with transfer of programmes over 2 months.	**13 March 1993** MSF at the UN humanitarian assistance coordination meeting for Somalia: The plan proposed within the UNOSOM framework has little chance of being implemented while the security problems are not resolved.
	15-28 March 1993 Somali factions make an agreement to set up a 'national council of transition' and general disarmament.			**15 March 1993** MSF Belgium coordinator to Reuters: "It's much worse now [with the UN troops]. Kismayo has never been so violent. Our programme here has been set back by 6-8 weeks."
	Mid-March 1993 Visit to Kismayo by Belgian Minister Leo Delcroix and Belgian Secretary of State for Cooperation Erik Derycke. They question the work of NGOs.			**16 March 1993** MSF Holland Press Release: 'Protection by United Nations' Soldiers – Somalia: the Médecins Sans Frontières Team in Baidoa Complete Again'.
			17 -18 March 1993 MSF Belgium asks MSF France not to justify its withdrawal by declaring the country's emergency is 'at an end'.	**17 March 1993** MSF Belgium Press Release and Press conference: 'Médecins Sans Frontières Belgium Shocked and Outraged by the Opinions held by Ministers Delcroix and Derycke Following their Brief Visit to Somalia'.

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1993 **MAR. 1993**	**26 March 1993** In Mogadishu, US soldiers, feeling threatened by stones thrown at their vehicles, shoot into the crowds, wounding children. In Kismayo, while Jess' troops attempt to take over the town, the UNITAF carries out a naval air show of force in the bay.	**26 March 1993** UNSG gives its backing to a large-scale peacekeeping operation, dubbed UNOSOM II, that will gradually take over from UNITAF, with 28,000 troops and 2,800 civilian staff.	**26 March 1993** An MSF Holland security guard is shot dead by an Australian soldier.	
APRIL 1993				**April 1993** Rony Brauman, President of MSF France Board of Directors in *Messages* (internal newsletter): 'Médecins Sans Frontières and the UN: Between Us, It's Ambiguous'.
			8 April 1993 MSF France decides to close the Kansardhere programme.	
		19 April 1993 UNITAF is officially replaced by UNOSOM II.		
				23 April 1993 The Dutch media announces that MSF Holland is planning to withdraw from Baidoa.
			26 April 1993 MSF Holland programme in Baidoa is terminated.	

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1993 **MAY 1993**			**4 May 1993** The final programmes run by MSF France in Somalia are officially closed. 1 coordinator stays to close the Hudur programme, to assess the other missions and relations with UNOSOM, and to identify other potential zones to explore.	**3 May 1993** MSF Holland Press Release: 'Somalia: Security Conditions No Longer Acceptable in Baidoa – Médecins Sans Frontières Suspends its Aid Programme'. **Early May 1993** Peter Casaer, former MSF Belgium Coordinator in Somalia, writes report on the conduct of the Belgian paratrooper commandos and sends it to the Belgian king, but no plans to distribute it publicly. **15 May 1993** MSF France president of Board of Directors' annual report, "epidemic of the militarisation of humanitarian aid". **26-27 May 1993** MSF France at OFDA meeting to review the military-humanitarian operations: the military intervention happened too late. The military/humanitarian confusion has negative repercussions on the security of relief workers.

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1993 **JUNE 1993**			**June 1993** Closure of MSF France mission in Hudur.	
	5 June 1993 23 Pakistani UNOSOM II soldiers are killed during a confrontation near a radio station controlled by Aidid.	**6 June 1993** UNSC Resolution 837 condemns attacks on the United Nations operation in Somalia and calls for arrests. **9 June 1993** AICF announces the suspension of all its missions in Somalia due to the climate of insecurity.		
	11 June 1993 UNOSOM II's air force launches night attacks on the neighbourhoods supporting Aidid, with the aim of destroying the radio and locations presumed to be holding weapons piles.		**11 June 1993** Surgical team from MSF France lands in Mogadishu.	**11 June 1993** MSF France and MSF Spain share a declaration drawn up by NGOs operating in Somalia for the special representative of the UN's secretary general for UNOSOM II, expressing concern about the consequences of large-scale operations led by the UN forces in Mogadishu.

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1993 **JUNE 1993**	**13 June 1993** At least 14 people, including women and children, are killed while a demonstration is stamped out by the UNOSOM forces.	**13 June 1993** Leading US political and military figures express their regrets for civilian deaths but state that the UN's actions can be defended, accusing General Aidid of using women and children as human shields. US House Democrats ask if the rules of engagement have not been shattered and predict that this sort of incident will happen again.	**13 June 1993** The MSF team treats some of the wounded from the UNOSOM attack.	**13 June 1993** AFP (France): 'The killing by U.N. troops in Mogadishu of at least 14 Somali demonstrators was slated Sunday as "monstrous" by the president of French medical agency Medecins Sans Frontieres.'
				14 June 1993 MSF Belgium/MSF France/MSF Holland/ MSF Spain Press Release: 'MSF statement against the killing of civilians in Mogadishu'.
				15 June 1993 MSF France Press Release: "A surgical team from Médecins Sans Frontières has been in Mogadishu since 11 June to respond to the emergency medical needs associated with the gradual deterioration of the situation in the Somali capital."
	17 June 1993 UNOSOM forces launch air and land interventions in Aidid's neighbourhood, causing the deaths of 60 Somalis, wounding 60, and destroying dozens of buildings. Digfer hospital, where some Aidid partisans are hiding out, is bombed during the course of the morning.	**Night of 16-17 June 1993** UN's special envoy in Somalia gives an order to arrest General Aidid, whom he qualifies as a "threat to the security of Somalis and the international community".		**17 June 1993** MSF France Press Release: 'UNOSOM Forces Attack Relief Base – MSF Calls for Official Enquiry'.

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1993 **JUNE 1993**		**18 June 1993** US President Bill Clinton declares that the operation in Somalia had "ended" and was a success.		
JULY 1993		**Early July 1993** Africa Rights accuses the Belgian military contingent of violent and racist acts against Somali civilians. Media and international community steps up criticism of the UN forces' strategy and urges them to resume discussions with General Aidid.	**Mid-July 1993** Peter Casaer, former MSF Belgium Coordinator, gives an updated version of the report sent to the king in May to the minister of defence.	**Early July 1993** Peter Casaer, former MSF Belgium Coordinator in Somalia, confirms to the media that his team in Kismayo has witnessed abuses, and refuses to participate in an inquiry under the Ministry of Defence.
	12 July 1993 UNOSOM forces shell 1 of General Aidid's houses where elders, clan and local leaders are meeting. A mob kills 4 foreign journalists in retaliation.			**20 July 1993** MSF France submits an appeal "for violation of humanitarian law in Somalia during UNOSOM operations on 17 July" to the United Nations Security Council, the Military High Command, and national commands of the United Nations forces in Somalia. **27 July 1993** MSF France/MSF USA Press Release: 'Médecins sans Frontières (MSF)/Doctors Without Borders submits an appeal to the United Nations'.

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1993 **JULY 1993**				**Late July 1993** MSF France information campaign on MSF appeal led among relevant UN actors and in the member countries, in particular among the US senators.
AUG. 1993		**5 August 1993** *The Washington Post* (USA) reports on an internal report in the legal department of the United Nations on Somalia, severely criticising the attack by the US forces on 12 July on the house sheltering Somali elders. **10 August 1993** 26 NGOs working in Somalia publicly criticise the direction taken by UNOSOM II, highlighting the ethical and legal issues raised by its actions. **22 August 1993** US leaders decide to send a unit of rangers to Somalia and announce that General Aidid needs to be "eliminated from the Somali equation".		**24 August 1993** Aktueel (VRT, Belgium Radio): Belgian paratroopers recount, and attempt to justify, the 'blunders' that they committed in Somalia.

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1993				
AUG. 1993	**30 August 1993** UNOSOM launches a new helicopter operation in the Digfer hospital area, where the home of General Aidid is located.	**30 August 1993** AICF denounces the use of its premises by the UNOSOM II forces for an operation aiming to capture local personnel tasked with providing security for the neighbouring premises used.		
SEPT. 1993		**September 1993** Regarding the accusations against the Belgian paratroopers, an inquiry commission is set up in Belgium, composed of senior officers and the national defence's director of civil administration.	**15 September 1993** MSF France introduces an appeal regarding the attack of the base in June, this one to the United National Administrative Tribunal of the UN.	**September 1993** 'Somalia – A Humanitarian Crime', essay by Rony Brauman, President of MSF France Board of Directors, published by Editions Arléa. **26 September 1993** MSF France representative in Somalia to AFP (France): MSF France is going to have nothing more to do with Somalia and will pack its bags. **27 September 1993** AFP (France): 'Relief Group Blasts UN, Pulls Out of Mogadishu.' 'Belgian Aid Group to Stay in Somalia'. **28 September 1993** Reuters: 'MSF France leaves Somalia'.
OCT. 1993	**3 October 1993** UN forces reinforced by US commandos launch a vast operation in Mogadishu against the troops led by General Aidid; at least 500 Somalis and 19 US soldiers killed, 1 pilot is captured.			**3 October 1993** AFP (France): 'Aid Boss Slams US, UN'.

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1993 **OCT. 1993**	**4 October 1993** Aidid publicly demands 'a stop to the massacre of Somalis'.		**5 October 1993** MSF France leaders re-examine the need to launch a further intervention in Somalia.	
	6 October 1993 Bodies of US soldiers are paraded and a captured pilot is humiliated in Mogadishu.			**6 October 1993** Rony Brauman, MSF France President of Board of Directors, to Antenne 2 (France): MSF France is withdrawing from Somalia to avoid being held hostage by the military-humanitarian system. MSF France is going to send a team to Mogadishu to provide support for any surgical emergencies.
		7 October 1993 US President Bill Clinton announces they are sending 1,700 additional troops to Somalia. US State Department immediately calls for its nationals to leave Somalia.	**7-20 October 1993** MSF France exploratory mission in south Mogadishu.	**7 October 1993** AFP (France): 'MSF Fears a New Wave of Violence in Mogadishu'.
		8 October 1993 US President Bill Clinton announces that the solution to the problems in Somalia are political and not military.		

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1993 **OCT. 1993**				**12 October 1993** Rony Brauman, President of MSF France Board of Directors, to *La Croix* (France): "Most of the patients treated by MSF in Somalia have been injured by the Blue Helmets."
			20 October 1993 MSF France managers ask themselves if they should return to Mogadishu to treat the 20 per cent of wounded civilians not being treated by the ICRC or Somali doctors.	
				21 October 1993 'Envoyé Spécial' programme on Antenne 2 (France): Patrick Vial, representative of MSF France in Somalia, wondered whether the calls for aid to fight famine didn't ultimately have a part in aggravating Somali misfortune.
			29 October 1993 MSF France exploratory mission in Mogadishu.	

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1993 **NOV. 1993**				**18 November 1993** MSF France Press Conference on *Populations in Danger* (MSF France publication). Reuters (UK): Rony Brauman, MSF France President of Board of Directors, "In Somalia, the United Nations pose a fatal threat to humanitarians." – Alain Destexhe, MSF International General Secretary: "The results of the UN operations in Somalia, as in Bosnia, are negative on both a humanitarian and a political level."
DEC. 1993		**December 1993** Belgian inquiry commission issues a report which recognises that unacceptable abuses were committed by the Belgian paratroopers in Kismayo, but considers them isolated cases.		
1994 **MAR. 1994**		**March 1994** Withdrawal of the last US soldiers from Somalia.		
1995	UNOSOM troops leave Somalia.			